

Answer Key with Rationale

Diarrhea and Dehydration in Children – Part A

Questions 1–7

Question 1. Answer: A

Rationale: Text A classifies diarrhea as acute (fewer than 14 days), persistent (14 days or more but fewer than 30 days), and chronic (beyond 30 days).

Question 2. Answer: D

Rationale: Text D presents a five-step protocol covering initial assessment, dehydration classification, rehydration plan, nutritional support, and discharge planning.

Question 3. Answer: C

Rationale: Text C table: "Altered consciousness or lethargy" is a sign of severe dehydration; recommended action is "Commence intravenous fluid resuscitation".

Question 4. Answer: B

Rationale: Text B: "Rotavirus vaccination has demonstrated effectiveness in reducing the incidence of severe rotavirus diarrhea in children."

Question 5. Answer: D

Rationale: Text D, Step 4: "Feeding should not be withheld during diarrhea."

Question 6. Answer: B

Rationale: Text B identifies "poor sanitation" and "Lack of breastfeeding in infancy removes a key source of passive immunity" as environmental risk factors.

Question 7. Answer: A

Rationale: Text A: "Dehydration is the most serious complication of diarrhea and is classified as mild, moderate, or severe based on clinical signs." This phrasing is specific to Text A.

Questions 8–14

Question 8. Answer: three (3)

Rationale: "Diarrhea is defined as the passage of three or more loose or watery stools within a 24-hour period." (Text A, paragraph 1)

Question 9. Answer: rotavirus

Rationale: "Rotavirus remains the most common viral cause globally." (Text A, paragraph 3)

Question 10. Answer: two (2)

Rationale: "children under two years of age being at greatest risk" (Text B, paragraph 2)

Question 11. Answer: duration and severity

Rationale: "Zinc supplementation given alongside ORS has been shown to reduce the duration and severity of acute diarrheal episodes." (Text B, paragraph 5)

Question 12. Answer: persistent

Rationale: "Persistent diarrhea is defined as an episode lasting 14 days or more but fewer than 30 days." (Text A, paragraph 2)

Question 13. Answer: intravenous

Rationale: "Severe dehydration requires prompt intravenous fluid resuscitation (Plan C)." (Text D, Step 3)

Question 14. Answer: intestinal integrity

Rationale: "Continued feeding maintains intestinal integrity, supports recovery, and prevents malnutrition." (Text D, Step 4)

Questions 15–20

Question 15. Answer: sunken eyes

Rationale: Text C table: "Sunken eyes and dry mucous membranes" listed as clinical feature indicating moderate dehydration.

Question 16. Answer: oral rehydration solution (ORS)

Rationale: Text B: "Oral rehydration solution (ORS) administration at the onset of diarrhea prevents progression to significant dehydration."

Question 17. Answer: hypovolemic shock

Rationale: Text A: "Continued fluid and nutritional loss without adequate replacement may lead to hypovolemic shock." Also referenced in Text C note.

Question 18. Answer: exclusive breastfeeding

Rationale: Text B: "Exclusive breastfeeding for the first six months of life is strongly recommended and significantly reduces diarrheal morbidity."

Question 19. Answer: nutritional assessment

Rationale: Text C table: "Persistent diarrhea exceeding 14 days | Risk of malnutrition and micronutrient deficiency | Conduct nutritional assessment and refer to specialist."

Question 20. Answer: warning signs / when to seek further medical attention

Rationale: Text D, Step 5: "Caregivers should be educated on recognising warning signs and when to seek further medical attention."

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